

webdriver — browser automation with Babet

webdriver.lua is a **W3C WebDriver Classic** client for Babet 2.9.0 or newer. Since version 2.0.0, webdriver_bidi.lua adds **WebDriver BiDi** on top of the native WebSocket client provided by Babet 2.22.0 or newer. The library drives Firefox, Chrome and Chromium through geckodriver or chromedriver. Babet is available from its [official GitHub repository](#).

Table of contents

- [Installation](#)
- [Starting a new project](#)
- [Creating a session](#)
- [Start options](#)
- [Driver lifecycle](#)
- [Navigation](#)
- [Locating elements and waiting](#)
- [Elements](#)
- [JavaScript](#)
- [Keyboard, mouse and wheel actions](#)
- [Windows, tabs and frames](#)
- [Alerts, cookies and timeouts](#)
- [Screenshots](#)
- [Automatic driver management](#)
- [WebDriver BiDi](#)
- [Workers and channels](#)
- [Error contract](#)
- [Limitations](#)

Installation

The files webdriver.lua, webdriver_version.lua, driver_manager.lua and, depending on the selected mode, webdriver_worker.lua, webdriver_bidi.lua and webdriver_bidi_worker.lua must be reachable through package.path.

```
local webdriver = require("webdriver")
```

The library requires:

- [Babet 2.9.0 or newer](#) for WebDriver Classic;
- Babet 2.22.0 or newer for WebDriver BiDi and the complete 2.0 test suite;
- Linux;
- Firefox, Chrome or Chromium;
- geckodriver or chromedriver, either installed or downloadable.

It does not require tar, unzip, curl, base64 or an external shell.

Starting a new project

What to download

A new application needs two independent pieces:

1. **babel-webdriver**: download the source archive for the desired version from [babel-webdriver Releases](#). The runtime is made of Lua modules; there is no separate installation step.
2. **Babet**: download a Linux build from [Babet Releases](#), or build it from the [Babet repository](#). Use Babet **2.22.0 or newer** to enable the complete 2.0 feature set. A Classic-only project needs at least **2.9.0**. On a typical 64-bit Intel/AMD Linux machine, choose the babel-<version>-linux-x86_64 release asset; ARM builds are published separately.

If you do not want to choose modules feature by feature, copying all runtime files is the simplest and safest layout:

```

my-project/
├── bin/
│   └── babet
├── webdriver.lua
├── webdriver_version.lua
├── driver_manager.lua
├── webdriver_worker.lua
├── webdriver_bidi.lua
├── webdriver_bidi_worker.lua
└── main.lua

```

```

chmod +x bin/babet
./bin/babet main.lua

```

The bin/babet location is optional: Babet may instead be installed in PATH or invoked through an arbitrary absolute path. Likewise, the Lua modules may be moved to another directory if that directory is added to package.path. Development content (tests/, examples/, docs/, tools/, run_*.sh, build_docs.sh) is not required in an application project.

geckodriver and chromedriver are not part of either source archive. They may be provided in PATH, selected through driver_path, or installed by driver_manager.lua. An unknown first download is rejected unless it is explicitly authorized with trust_on_first_use = true, or checked with expected_sha256.

Direct project: required files

To drive a browser from the main script, copy only:

```

my-project/
├── webdriver.lua
├── webdriver_version.lua
├── driver_manager.lua
└── main.lua

```

webdriver.lua loads webdriver_version.lua and driver_manager.lua internally. All three modules are therefore required even when geckodriver or chromedriver is already installed.

When the modules are next to main.lua, loading is direct:

```

local webdriver = require("webdriver")

```

Project using a worker

To host the WebDriver session inside a worker and communicate through channels, add the proxy module:

```

my-project/
├── webdriver.lua
├── webdriver_version.lua
├── driver_manager.lua
├── webdriver_worker.lua
└── main.lua

```

The main script then loads:

```

local webdriver_worker = require("webdriver_worker")

```

For direct BiDi, add webdriver_bidi.lua. For a dedicated BiDi worker, also add webdriver_bidi_worker.lua. A Classic session hosted by webdriver_worker.lua uses the same module when session:bidi() is called.

tools/check_env.lua is an optional diagnostic tool. The tests/, examples/ and docs/ directories, as well as build_docs.sh and the run_*.sh scripts, are not required in an application project.

Location of the Babet executable

The repository's `bin/` directory is only a convenient convention. Babet may be installed anywhere. It can be downloaded or built from its [GitHub repository](#), and `babet-webdriver` requires **2.9.0** or newer for the Classic client. WebDriver BiDi requires **Babet 2.22.0** or newer.

Project-local executable:

```
my-project/
├── bin/babet
├── webdriver.lua
├── webdriver_version.lua
├── driver_manager.lua
└── main.lua
```

```
./bin/babet main.lua
```

Babet installed in PATH:

```
babet main.lua
```

A shebang also allows:

```
#!/usr/bin/env babet
```

```
chmod +x main.lua
./main.lua
```

Babet at an arbitrary path:

```
/opt/babet/bin/babet main.lua
```

Inside the `babet-webdriver` repository, `run_tests.sh`, `run_smoke.sh`, `run_worker_smoke.sh` and `run_all_tests.sh` locate the executable in this order:

1. the path provided through `BABET`;
2. `bin/babet`;
3. a `babet` command available in `PATH`.

Example:

```
BABET=/opt/babet/bin/babet ./run_tests.sh
```

To run the complete validation campaign with a single command:

```
./run_all_tests.sh
```

The script enables headless mode by default, keeps the full progress visible in the terminal and copies the exact same output to `babet-webdriver-tests.txt`. The log is first written to a unique temporary file in the destination directory and is atomically published only when the campaign finishes. An existing complete log is therefore never truncated while tests are running, and accidentally parallel campaigns never mix their contents. If several campaigns target the same path, the one that finishes last simply becomes the current log. A completed campaign, whether successful or failed, replaces the previous log so it can be shared as-is. Use `HEADLESS=0` to display the browsers, or `TEST_LOG=/path/test.txt` to select another file.

Complete minimal example

```
#!/usr/bin/env babet

local webdriver = require("webdriver")

local driver, err = webdriver.firefox({ headless = true })
if not driver then
    io.stderr:write(tostring(err), "\n")
    os.exit(1)
end
```

```

end

local ok, run_err = xpcall(function()
    assert(driver:open("https://example.com"))
    print(assert(driver:title()))

    local heading = assert(driver:css("h1"))
    print(assert(heading:text()))
end, debug.traceback)

local quit_ok, quit_err = driver:quit()
if not quit_ok then
    io.stderr:write("WebDriver shutdown: ", tostring(quit_err), "\n")
end

if not ok then
    io.stderr:write(tostring(run_err), "\n")
    os.exit(1)
end

```

Modules in a subdirectory

To keep the modules under lib/ instead:

```

my-project/
├── lib/
│   ├── webdriver.lua
│   ├── webdriver_version.lua
│   ├── driver_manager.lua
│   └── webdriver_worker.lua
└── main.lua

```

Add the directory before the first require:

```

package.path = "./lib/?.lua;" .. package.path

local webdriver = require("webdriver")

```

Creating a session

Firefox

```

local driver, err = webdriver.firefox({
    headless = true,
})
assert(driver, err)

```

Chrome or Chromium

```

local chrome = assert(webdriver.chrome({ headless = true }))
local chromium = assert(webdriver.chromium({ headless = true }))

```

The convenience constructors never modify the caller's option table.

Generic form

```

local driver = assert(webdriver.start({
    browser = "firefox",

```

```
    headless = true,
  )))
```

Start options

Browser and capabilities

Option	Type	Default	Description
browser	string	firefox	firefox, chrome, chromium
headless	boolean	false	adds the browser-specific headless arguments
args	dense array	{}	browser command-line arguments
binary	string	automatic for Chromium	explicit browser executable
user_data_dir	string	absent	explicit Chrome/Chromium profile
window_size	{w,h}	absent	initial window size
accept_insecure_certs	boolean	false	corresponding W3C capability
bidirectional	boolean	false	requests webSocketUrl and negotiates

```
local driver = assert(webdriver.firefox({
  headless = true,
  args = { "--private-window" },
  binary = "/usr/lib/firefox/firefox",
  window_size = { 1600, 1000 },
  accept_insecure_certs = false,
}))
```

For `webdriver.chromium()`, the executable is searched in `PATH` under the names `chromium` and then `chromium-browser`. For `webdriver.chrome()`, the library tries `google-chrome-stable`, `google-chrome` and then `chrome`, but lets `ChromeDriver` apply its own normal detection when none of those names is found.

Chromium distributed as a Snap

`ChromeDriver` normally creates a temporary profile. With Chromium installed as a Snap, that profile may be outside the filesystem space visible through Snap confinement, which can cause `DevToolsActivePort` file doesn't exist.

When the detected executable is under `/snap/bin/` or `/snap/chromium/`, the library therefore creates a temporary profile under:

```
~/snap/chromium/common/babet-webdriver/profiles/
```

That profile is passed through `--user-data-dir=...` and removed from `driver:quit()`. The library does not add `--no-sandbox`; the browser sandbox remains enabled.

An explicit profile is still supported:

```
local driver = assert(webdriver.chromium({
  headless = true,
  user_data_dir = os.getenv("HOME") .. "/snap/chromium/common/my-profile",
}))
```

`user_data_dir` cannot be combined with a manually supplied `--user-data-dir=...` argument in `args`. A profile supplied by the caller is never removed automatically.

External driver

Option	Type	Default	Description
driver_path	string	PATH lookup	explicit driver path

Option	Type	Default	Description
auto_install	boolean	true	installs the driver when missing
trust_on_first_use	boolean	false	permits the first unpinned artifact
expected_sha256	hexadecimal string	absent	expected archive hash
platform	string	automatic	forced platform key
cache	string	default cache	cache directory
force_driver_download	boolean	false	forces reinstallation

Port and connection

Option	Type	Default	Description
port	integer	automatic	WebDriver server port
port_attempts	integer	5	retries for automatic port selection
attach	boolean	false	uses an external driver ready to create a new session
start_timeout	seconds	15	startup time budget
status_timeout	seconds	1	timeout for each /status probe
poll_interval	seconds	0.1	delay between probes

Without an explicit port, the library asks the kernel for a free port. The temporary socket must then be closed before the driver starts, so a small race window remains. `port_attempts` lets the library retry when another process takes the port in that interval.

In attach mode, the external driver must answer `/status` with `ready=true`, so it must be available to create **a new session**. This mode does not resume an existing Selenium session. In particular, `geckodriver` normally reports `ready=false` while already occupied; `babet-webdriver` then reports it as reachable but unavailable instead of misdiagnosing a network failure.

In attach mode, the historical defaults are preserved:

- Firefox: 4444;
- Chrome/Chromium: 9515.

```
local driver = assert(webdriver.firefox({
  attach = true,
  port = 4444,
}))
```

HTTP, screenshots and logs

Option	Default	Description
request_timeout	120 s	WebDriver command timeout
max_body_size	64 MiB	maximum HTTP response body
screenshot_max_size	64 MiB	limit after Base64 decoding
screenshot_permissions	0644	permissions of the published PNG
screenshot_durable	true	fsyncs the file and directory
print_max_size	64 MiB	limit after PDF Base64 decoding
print_permissions	0644	permissions of the published PDF
print_durable	true	fsyncs the PDF and directory
log_path	automatic	exact log file
log_dir	cache/logs	automatic log directory
log_append	true	appends instead of truncating
log_permissions	0600	creation permissions
terminate_grace	2 s	grace period before SIGKILL

Options are strict. A typo such as `timeot = 5` immediately raises a Lua programming error.

Driver lifecycle

When the library starts the driver, it keeps the object returned by `babet.spawn()`:

```
print(driver:pid())
print(driver:port())
print(driver:log_path())
print(driver:is_running())
```

The streams are configured as follows:

- `stdin` is connected to `/dev/null`;
- `stdout` is redirected to the log file;
- `stderr` is merged into `stdout`.

No shell interprets the executable path or its arguments.

Closing

```
local ok, err = driver:quit()
assert(ok, err)
```

`quit()`:

1. requests deletion of the W3C session;
2. sends `SIGTERM` to the driver process group;
3. waits for `terminate_grace`;
4. uses `SIGKILL` when necessary;
5. closes the Babet descriptors.

The method is idempotent. `driver:close()` is an alias. The object also exposes an `__close` metamethod for Lua to-be-closed variables.

Navigation

```
assert(driver:open("https://example.com"))
print(assert(driver:url()))
print(assert(driver:title()))
print(assert(driver:source()))
assert(driver:back())
assert(driver:forward())
assert(driver:refresh())
```

Locating elements and waiting

Strategies

```
driver:find("main h1") -- CSS
driver:find("//main//h1", { by = "xpath" })
driver:find("submit", { by = "id" })
driver:find("email", { by = "name" })
driver:find("button", { by = "tag" })
driver:find("active", { by = "class" })
driver:find("Home", { by = "link" })
driver:find("Hom", { by = "plink" })
```

Convenience methods:

```
driver:css(selector)
driver:xpath(selector)
driver:id(value)
```

```
driver:name(value)
driver:tag(value)
```

id, name and class are converted to correctly escaped CSS selectors.

One element

```
local element, err = driver:css("h1")
assert(element, err)
```

When no element matches, the server returns the W3C no such element error.

Multiple elements

```
local elements = assert(driver:find_all("article"))
for _, element in ipairs(elements) do
    print(assert(element:text()))
end
```

An empty array is a normal successful result.

Checking presence

```
local exists, err = driver:exists("#optional")
assert(exists ~= nil, err)
if exists then
    print("present")
end
```

Only no such element becomes false. A network failure, a closed session or a dead driver remains an error.

Waiting for a state

```
local button = assert(driver:wait("#submit", {
    state = "clickable",
    timeout = 20,
    interval = 0.2,
}))
```

States:

- present: the element is found;
- visible: found and displayed;
- clickable: displayed and enabled;
- gone: absence is confirmed.

By default, a stale reference causes a fresh lookup. Other errors are returned immediately.

Custom wait

```
local result = assert(driver:wait_until(function()
    local value, err = driver:js("return window.appReady === true")
    if value == nil and err then return nil, err end
    return value
end, 30, 0.25))
```

A callback exception or an error returned as the second value is not silently ignored.

Elements

Simple actions

```
assert(element:click())
assert(element:clear())
assert(element:type("Hello"))
assert(element:submit())
```

submit() finds the enclosing form through JavaScript and prefers requestSubmit() when available.

Reading values

```
print(assert(element:text()))
print(assert(element:tag()))
print(assert(element:rect()).width)
print(assert(element:css("display")))
print(assert(element:property("value")))
print(assert(element:dom_attr("data-id")))
print(assert(element:attr("textContent")))
print(assert(element:value()))
print(assert(element:computed_role()))
print(assert(element:computed_label()))
```

attr() mirrors Selenium's practical behavior: it tries the HTML attribute and then the DOM property. If neither exists, it returns nil without an error. Generic JavaScript results still preserve `babet.json.null`.

Boolean states

```
local displayed, err = element:displayed()
assert(displayed ~= nil, err)
```

displayed, enabled and selected propagate errors. They no longer turn an error into false.

Nested lookup

```
local row = assert(driver:css("tr.active"))
local button = assert(row:find("button.save"))
local cells = assert(row:find_all("td"))
```

W3C Shadow DOM:

```
local host = assert(driver:css("my-component"))
local shadow = assert(host:shadow_root())
assert(webdriver.is_shadow_root(shadow))
local button = assert(shadow:find("button.primary"))
local items = assert(shadow:find_all("li"))
```

The currently active element is available through `driver:active_element()`.

JavaScript

```
local text = assert(driver:js(
  "return arguments[0].textContent",
  element
))
```

Element objects passed as arguments are serialized with the W3C element key. Elements returned by the script are rebuilt automatically, including inside a nested table.

Cyclic tables are rejected before the request is sent. A JavaScript null value is preserved as `babet.json.null`, keeping it distinct from an error-signalling Lua `nil`. The W3C asynchronous variant is exposed through `js_async()`:

```
local value = assert(driver:js_async([[
  const done = arguments[arguments.length - 1];
  setTimeout(() => done("ready"), 10);
]]))
```

Keyboard, mouse and wheel actions

```
assert(driver:actions()
  :move_to(element)
  :click()
  :send_keys("Hello")
  :perform())
```

Methods:

```
move_to(element [, x, y])
move_by(x, y)
click([element])
double_click([element])
context_click([element])
click_and_hold([element])
release()
key_down(character)
key_up(character)
send_keys(text)
pause(milliseconds)
scroll(delta_x, delta_y [, opts])
drag_and_drop(source, destination)
perform()
clear()
```

The builder aligns keyboard, pointer and wheel sources tick by tick. `scroll()` emits a W3C wheel source; its origin may be "viewport" or an Element, with optional x, y and duration. Coordinates, deltas and duration are integers as required by the protocol; `move_to()`, `move_by()` and `pause()` apply the same strict validation. `perform()` resets the sequences.

Special keys are exposed through `webdriver.keys`, for example:

```
webdriver.keys.ENTER
webdriver.keys.CONTROL
webdriver.keys.DELETE
webdriver.keys.F1
webdriver.keys.SEPARATOR
webdriver.keys.RIGHT_SHIFT
webdriver.keys.RIGHT_CONTROL
webdriver.keys.RIGHT_ALT
webdriver.keys.RIGHT_META
```

Windows, tabs and frames

```
local current = assert(driver:window())
local handles = assert(driver:windows())
assert(driver:switch(handles[#handles]))
assert(driver:switch_last())
```

```

local new_handle = assert(driver:new_tab())
local window_handle, kind = assert(driver:new_window("window"))
assert(kind == "window")
assert(driver:close_window())

```

Window rectangles:

```

assert(driver:set_window_rect({ x = 0, y = 0, width = 1280, height = 900 }))
local rect = assert(driver:window_rect())
assert(driver:maximize())
assert(driver:minimize())
assert(driver:fullscreen())

```

Frames:

```

assert(driver:frame(0))
assert(driver:frame(frame_element))
assert(driver:parent_frame())
assert(driver:top_frame())

```

Alerts, cookies and timeouts

Alerts

```

print(assert(driver:alert_text()))
assert(driver:alert_send("answer"))
assert(driver:accept_alert())
assert(driver:dismiss_alert())

```

Cookies

```

local cookies = assert(driver:cookies())
local theme = assert(driver:cookie("theme"))
assert(driver:set_cookie({ name = "theme", value = "dark" }))
assert(driver:delete_cookie("theme"))
assert(driver:clear_cookies())

```

A cookie name is encoded as a URL path segment; slashes, spaces and other characters cannot break the WebDriver path.

W3C timeouts

Values are expressed in seconds:

```

assert(driver:set_timeouts({
  implicit = 0,
  page_load = 60,
  script = 30,
}))
local timeouts = assert(driver:get_timeouts())
print(timeouts.page_load)

-- W3C allows null to remove a limit when the driver supports it.
assert(driver:set_timeouts({ script = babet.json.null }))

```

Screenshots

Without a path, the Base64 string is returned:

```
local encoded = assert(driver:screenshot())
local element_encoded = assert(element:screenshot())
```

With a path, Babet decodes the binary data and publishes the file atomically:

```
assert(driver:screenshot("captures/page.png"))
assert(element:screenshot("captures/button.png"))
```

The parent directory is created recursively when necessary. Atomic publication ensures that a reader sees either the previous complete file or the new one, never a partial PNG.

W3C printing returns a Base64 PDF or publishes it atomically when a path is provided:

```
local encoded_pdf = assert(driver:print({ orientation = "portrait" }))
assert(driver:print({
    orientation = "landscape",
    background = true,
    page = { width = 21, height = 29.7 },
    margin = { top = 1, bottom = 1, left = 1, right = 1 },
    page_ranges = { "1-2", 4 },
}, "captures/page.pdf"))
```

Automatic driver management

driver_manager.lua can also be used directly:

```
local manager = require("driver_manager")
local path = assert(manager.install("firefox", {
    trust_on_first_use = true,
}))
```

Resolution

- geckodriver: latest official GitHub release, unless driver_manager.gecko_version is forced;
- chromedriver: version matching the milestone of the Chrome or Chromium binary actually selected, unless driver_manager.chrome_version is forced.

Verification

The cache uses XDG_CACHE_HOME/babet-webdriver when available, otherwise:

```
~/.cache/babet-webdriver/pins/<driver>_<platform>_<version>.json
```

Without HOME, a private per-user/UID cache is selected under /tmp to avoid permission collisions between accounts.

Each record contains:

- the URL;
- the archive SHA-256;
- the extracted executable SHA-256;
- the version and platform.

A cached executable is reused only when its hash matches. Legacy pins.json files containing only a hash string are read for migration, but the new format is written under pins/.

TOFU

Without a known pin, installation fails by default. Setting trust_on_first_use = true trusts the first HTTPS download and stores its hashes.

This mode detects later modification. It does not prove that the first artifact was legitimate. For a stronger trust chain, supply expected_sha256 from an independent channel.

For release preflight, `RUN_INSTALL_SMOKE=1 ./run_all_tests.sh` creates a fresh temporary cache and exercises the real download, extraction, `chmod`, hashing, atomic publication, and pin reread paths for geckodriver and chromedriver without touching the user cache.

In CI, `BABET_WEBDRIVER_GITHUB_TOKEN`, `GH_TOKEN` or `GITHUB_TOKEN` may be set to authenticate the GitHub API request used for geckodriver. If a repository-scoped GitHub Actions `GITHUB_TOKEN` is rejected by the public geckodriver repository, the request is retried anonymously. The token is never sent to other hosts.

Extraction

The archive is never loaded entirely into Lua. Babet downloads it to a temporary file, verifies the hash, then extracts into a unique temporary file before atomically publishing the executable in the cache:

- geckodriver for Firefox;
- chromedriver-`<platform>`/chromedriver for Chrome.

Anti-bomb limits apply to the complete archive.

WebDriver BiDi

Version 2.0.0 adds WebDriver BiDi without replacing WebDriver Classic. The HTTP session is created normally with the `W3C websocketUrl = true` capability, then the client connects to the URL returned by the driver. Classic and BiDi commands therefore control **the same browser and the same session**.

Negotiation and direct client

```
local webdriver = require("webdriver")

local driver = assert(webdriver.firefox({
    headless = true,
    bidi = true,
}))

print(assert(driver:websocket_url()))
local bidi = assert(driver:bidi())
print(assert(bidi:status()).ready)
```

`bidi = true` requires Babet 2.22.0 or newer and `babet.websocket`. If the driver accepts session creation but does not return a usable `websocketUrl`, `babet-webdriver` fails creation and cleans up the session, driver process and temporary profile.

Connection options accepted by `driver:bidi(options)`:

Option	Default	Description
<code>timeout</code>	5 s	WebSocket connection timeout
<code>command_timeout</code>	30 s	BiDi command budget
<code>close_timeout</code>	5 s	close-handshake budget
<code>event_queue_limit</code>	1024	maximum queued events
<code>verify</code>	Babet	TLS verification for <code>wss://</code>
<code>ca_cert</code> , <code>ca_path</code> , <code>hostname</code> , <code>min_version</code>	Babet	TLS parameters passed to the transport
<code>max_message_bytes</code> , <code>max_frame_bytes</code>	Babet	transport size limits

Typed commands

The 2.0.0 core surface includes:

```

local status = assert(bidi:status())
local tree = assert(bidi:get_tree({ max_depth = 0 }))
local context = tree.contexts[1].context

local navigation = assert(bidi:navigate(
    context,
    "https://example.com",
    { wait = "complete" }
))

local evaluation = assert(bidi:evaluate("document.title", context))
local realms = assert(bidi:get_realms({ context = context }))

```

evaluate() accepts either a browsing-context id or a target table. Supported options are await_promise, result_ownership, serialization_options and user_activation.

The BiDi standard evolves independently from babet-webdriver releases. For a command that does not yet have a convenience wrapper, call() provides the low-level escape hatch:

```

local result = assert(bidi:call("browser.getUserContexts", {}))

```

Subscriptions and events

```

local subscription = assert(bidi:subscribe({
    "log.entryAdded",
    "network.beforeRequestSent",
}, {
    contexts = { context },
}))

local event, err, code = bidi:next_event(5)
if event then
    print(event.method)
elseif code ~= "timeout" then
    error(err)
end

assert(bidi:unsubscribe(subscription))

```

Events that arrive while a command response is pending are retained and never desynchronize command ids. The queue is bounded by event_queue_limit. When it overflows, excess events are counted and the synthetic babetWebDriver.eventOverflow event reports the loss.

An explicit callback interface is also available:

```

bidi:on("log.entryAdded", function(event)
    print(event.params.text)
end)

assert(bidi:dispatch(5, 10))

```

dispatch() runs callbacks in the calling Lua thread. No implicit concurrent callback can therefore interrupt an arbitrary user command.

Dedicated BiDi worker

driver:bidi_worker() moves the WebSocket connection into a separate worker:

```

local driver = assert(webdriver.chromium({ headless = true, bidi = true }))
local bidi = assert(driver:bidi_worker({ event_queue_limit = 1024 }))
local subscription = assert(bidi:subscribe("log.entryAdded"))

```

```

local context = assert(bidi:get_tree({ max_depth = 0 })).contexts[1].context
assert(bidi:evaluate("console.log('hello bidi')", context))
local event = assert(bidi:next_event(5))
print(event.method)

assert(bidi:unsubscribe(subscription))
assert(driver:quit())

```

For a Classic session already hosted by `webdriver_worker.lua`, the parent only needs to call `session:bidi()`. The BiDi worker is separate from the Classic worker and owns its own WebSocket.

Because `babet.websocket` is synchronous, this worker is command-driven: it waits on its parent channel and reads the WebSocket only while processing a BiDi command or `next_event()`. A long `next_event(timeout)` is read in bounded slices so worker cancellation remains responsive. It never polls the network while idle, preventing a WebSocket `recv()` from starving the next command. Events interleaved with a command are retained in the bounded BiDi client queue (`event_queue_limit`).

Worker-specific options are `channel_capacity`, `command_timeout`, `worker_start_timeout` and `stop_timeout`. BiDi client options, including `event_queue_limit`, are also accepted and forwarded to the transport.

`driver:quit()` and `session:stop()` automatically close an attached BiDi transport before ending the Classic session. BiDi objects also support Lua 5.4/5.5 to-be-closed variables through `__close`.

For `webdriver_worker`, `stop_timeout` (or the explicit timeout passed to `session:stop(timeout)`) is a global budget: it covers closing any attached BiDi worker first, then stopping and joining the Classic worker.

Workers and channels

`webdriver_worker.lua` keeps the session and driver process inside a persistent worker.

```

local worker_driver = require("webdriver_worker")
local session = assert(worker_driver.start({
    browser = "firefox",
    headless = true,
    channel_capacity = 64,
    command_timeout = 120,
}))

assert(session:open("https://example.com"))
local heading = assert(session:css("h1"))
print(assert(heading:text()))
assert(session:stop())

```

The parent response budget covers at least `request_timeout` plus a small transport margin. For `wait()`, it also covers the requested logical timeout and one final HTTP request, so the proxy cannot expire before its worker.

Before creating the worker, the parent prepares the driver when necessary. Concurrent installations remain safe: every extraction uses its own temporary file and the final executable is published atomically.

Element and Shadow DOM proxies

A WebDriver element is not sent as userdata. The worker sends its W3C id and the parent creates a proxy:

```
local element = assert(session:css("h1"))
assert(worker_driver.is_element(element))
print(element:element_id())
```

A ShadowRoot follows the same model:

```
local shadow = assert(element:shadow_root())
assert(worker_driver.is_shadow_root(shadow))
local button = assert(shadow:find("button"))
```

Proxies can be reused as arguments to `js()` or `frame()`. The internal transport also preserves `nil` arguments, including in the middle of an argument list, multiple return values, and the W3C error code.

Lifecycle

```
print(session:status())
assert(session:stop(10))
```

`stop()` first asks the worker to close the session cleanly. On timeout, Babel cancellation is requested. Cancellation remains cooperative, so every HTTP operation in the module is bounded.

A proxy session is synchronous and must have only one command in flight. Create multiple sessions for parallel execution.

The chainable actions() builder is not transported through the worker proxy. Chainable actions remain available on a direct session.

Error contract

An operational error returns:

```
nil, "webdriver: ..."
```

A WebDriver response preserves its W3C code in the message and, for methods that expose it such as `find()`, as a third return value:

```
local element, err, code = driver:find("#missing")
assert(element == nil and code == "no such element")
```

Example messages:

```
webdriver: no such element: element missing
webdriver: stale element reference: ...
webdriver: invalid session id: ...
```

Programming errors that raise a Lua exception include:

- unknown option;
- invalid type;
- sparse argument array;
- unknown locator strategy;
- invalid frame type;
- cyclic table passed to JavaScript.

Limitations

- the direct BiDi client is synchronous; use `bidi_worker()` to isolate the WebSocket loop;
- the typed 2.0.0 BiDi surface covers the session/browsingContext/script core; `call()` exposes the rest of the protocol;
- automatic driver management currently supports Linux only;
- Chrome for Testing provides a Linux x86-64 binary only;

- no authenticated or TLS remote proxy for the WebDriver server;
- no download resume;
- no progress callback;
- worker proxy limited to serializable methods and without the Actions builder;
- Babet channels carry JSON-like data, not binary strings containing NUL bytes.

WebDriver session in a worker

The complete integration path can be verified with:

```
HEADLESS=1 ./run_worker_smoke.sh firefox  
HEADLESS=1 ./run_worker_smoke.sh chromium
```

This test covers the parent process, channels, worker, driver process and real browser.